

Well, the average person does 90 000 hours of work over their life. You're probably at 20 000 hours (or so) yourself.

Your teen is at one hour.

Wouldn't it have been great if someone had taken *you* aside when you got your first job and explained how things really work?

Well, that's your job, Yoda.

And it's highly likely your teen has no freaking idea about what really happens in the workplace. That's not their fault—the school system brainwashes them into believing that the golden ticket to a career is getting a qualification. And when they have their shiny piece of paper, they get a job and . . . work?

Ha!

What they don't know is that the average workplace is really just another version of their high school classroom: there are people slacking off, gossiping, shirking responsibility, bitching about the boss (the teacher), and blaming everyone (except themselves).

A 2013 Gallup poll found that more than 70 per cent of Aussies are either 'ambivalent or completely disengaged with their jobs'.

Look, there are disengaged workers at McDonald's. And at the United Nations. And at every place you've ever worked. It's really not about the job at all . . . it's about the person.

The truth is that how you do *any* job is how you do *every* job.

The moment your teen steps into a workplace—no matter what the job—they're going to find the same situation: repetitive tasks, a social hierarchy, rules to follow, workplace politics.

As their Work Yoda, it's your job to help your teen work out who's who in the zoo, and how to spot the slackers.

They're easily recognisable by what they say and do. They only work hard when the boss is looking, and they say things like 'that's not *my* job' (at the same time as they're thinking, 'Of course, I'll work harder when I get a *real* job').